

instantaneous. Even light photo editing in Lightroom or Pixelmator Pro is handled with ease.

Where it really surprises is video editing. Editing 4K footage in DaVinci Resolve or Final Cut Pro is perfectly doable, especially for short projects. Scrolling through the timeline is smooth, preview playback doesn't stutter, and for most casual creators, the performance is impressive.

However, when you push it with extended 4K renders or long gameplay sessions, the fanless design starts to show its limitations. Unlike the MacBook Pro, which has active cooling, the Air does throttle after 25–30 minutes of sustained load. For instance, in our testing, Lies of P started at 60FPS and dropped to around 50FPS after extended play—a very acceptable performance dip, especially considering the laptop remains completely silent throughout.

Still, for users doing batch rendering or multi-hour projects, the MacBook Pro is the better choice. But for most creative professionals—especially those with bursty workloads—the Air is shockingly competent.

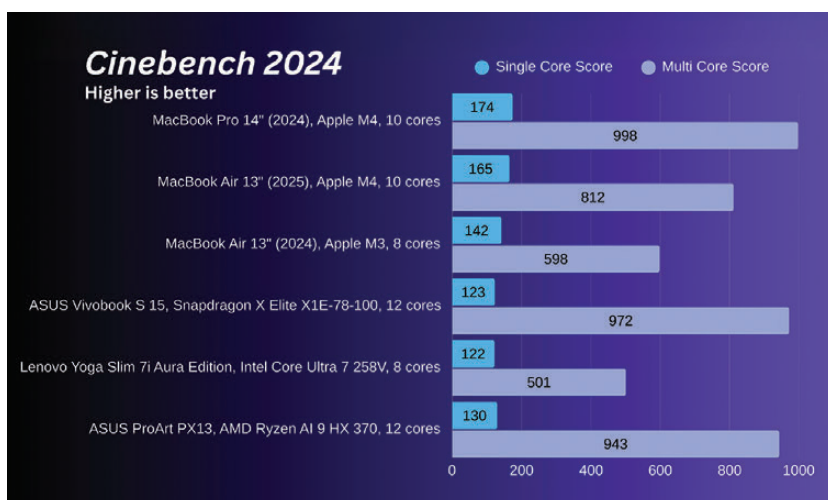
STORAGE AND REAL-WORLD USABILITY

The ₹99,900 base model comes with 256GB of storage, and while that might seem low in 2025, it's still usable. After installing apps like, Lies of P (Game), WhatsApp, Notion, Brave, DaVinci Resolve, and a few benchmark tools, we were left with around 139GB of free space. That's enough for many users, especially if your files are stored on iCloud or Google Drive.

Still, Apple's ₹20,000 charge for upgrading to 512GB feels steep. We recommend buying a high-quality external SSD (1TB for around ₹10,000) instead—it's cheaper, more flexible, and easier to upgrade in the future.

BATTERY LIFE

This is where the MacBook Air M4 truly shines. Apple claims up to 18 hours of battery life, and in our testing, those numbers held up. For basic tasks like



web browsing, document editing, and YouTube playback, we saw between 15.5 to 17.5 hours on a single charge. That's an entire workday and then some, making it one of the most dependable laptops for long-haul use.

Charging is handled via MagSafe 3, which is both fast and satisfying to use. You can also charge via USB-C in a pinch, but MagSafe remains the more elegant solution.

MACBOOK AIR M4 VS MACBOOK PRO M4: WHICH ONE'S RIGHT FOR YOU?

The comparison is inevitable. The MacBook Pro M4 (starting ₹1.69 lakh) comes with 16GB RAM, 512GB storage, active cooling, ProMotion 120Hz Mini-LED display, extra ports, and a 6-speaker system. It's made for power users, professionals working with massive files, and anyone needing sustained performance for long hours.

But the Air wins on value, portability, and silence. It's smaller, 360 grams lighter, and more affordable—without sacrificing much for 90% of users.

If you primarily deal with bursty tasks—photo editing, coding, short video projects, writing, presentations—the MacBook Air M4 is more than sufficient. If your day-to-day involves constant 4K video exports, 3D modelling, or music production, then the MacBook Pro is the smarter long-term investment.

FINAL VERDICT

The 13-inch Apple MacBook Air M4 (2025) is arguably the best value-for-money MacBook Apple has ever made. With double the RAM, a fresh new look, and that brilliant M4 chip—all at a lower price than the M3 variant, it's hard not to recommend it.

It's not a gaming beast, and it's not made for long-hour heavy renders. But for everyone else—students, writers, designers, coders, content creators, the M4 MacBook Air offers silent performance, unmatched battery life, a premium display, and one of the most travel-friendly form factors in the industry.

For ₹99,900, there are very few laptops in 2025 that offers this much efficiency, build quality, and power in such a compact and elegant package.

—Yetnesh Dubey

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Apple M4 SoC (3nm, 4 Performance + 4 Efficiency cores) | Graphics: 10-core Apple GPU | RAM: 16GB Unified Memory | Storage: 256GB SSD (base variant) | Display: 13.6-inch Liquid Retina, 2560×1664, 500 nits, P3 colour, True Tone | Battery: Up to 18 hours (Apple's claim) | Speakers: 4-speaker system with Spatial Audio | Webcam: 12MP with Centre Stage | Ports: 2x Thunderbolt/USB 4, MagSafe 3, 3.5mm headphone jack | Weight: 1.24kg | Price: ₹99,900 (16GB/256GB)

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